FACELESS48 · LESSON 9

Stock footage

Optional free B-roll from Pexels and Pixabay, with your own keys. You choose every clip.

> Everything in the plug-in works without stock footage. If you want B-roll to cut away to, here is how to add it.

Words in bold are what you say to your assistant.

What a key is

A key is like a library card. It lets the plug-in search for you. Keys are free and take about five minutes each. They stay on your computer. You can use just one provider.

1. Pexels key

Go to **pexels.com/api** and sign in. Click Your API Key and fill in the short form. The app name can be anything, like My video projects. Copy the key.

2. Pixabay key

Go to **pixabay.com/api/docs** and sign in. Scroll to Parameters. Your key is shown next to the word key. Copy it.

3. Where the keys go

In your project folder there is a file called stock-keys.example.json. Copy it and name the copy **stock-keys.json**. Paste each key between the quotes and save.

Then say: **Check my stock keys.** It tells you set or not set for each. It never prints your keys back.

Never paste your keys into chat, an email or a shared document. If you think one got out, make a new one on the website.

If your assistant runs in the cloud, set the keys as environment secrets instead of a file and allow api.pexels.com, videos.pexels.com, images.pexels.com, pixabay.com and cdn.pixabay.com.

4. Find footage

Say: **Find stock footage for this video.** It reads your script and turns each shot into a search phrase of two to four concrete words: what is in the frame, not the idea. Woman typing laptop night, not productivity.

5. You choose

It searches both sites and shows the options with where each is from, how long it is, who made it and a link to the clip's page, plus preview images. Open the links to watch the clips. You choose the ones you like.

6. Download and place

Only then does it download, one clip per choice. Each clip is saved into your project and its source and creator are recorded. A clip you choose can fade in as a cutaway over your talking-head video, move, and fade back to you, while your voice keeps playing.

7. Credits

When your video is done, say **Show me my stock credits.** It gives you a credit line for each clip, ready to paste into your caption or description.

Rules to know

Pixabay results are kept for 24 hours, so the same search within a day does not hit their service again. Clips are downloaded before use, never streamed from the site. The tool never bulk-downloads.

Both sites' licenses allow free use in videos, with limits. For anything sensitive, like an ad with a recognizable person or brand, read the license page yourself and check it again before you publish commercially.

If you see too many requests, wait a little and try again. If a portrait search hides some results, the tool tells you and you can ask to see everything.

Before you move on

- ☐ I made a Pexels or Pixabay key.
- ☐ I put my key in stock-keys.json and ran Check my stock keys.
- ☐ I searched, looked at the previews and chose a clip.
- ☐ I saved my stock credits for my caption.

Transcript

Welcome to lesson 9. This is where we talk about stock footage. Just to let you know, stock footage is optional. Everything in your Faceless48 Creator plugin works without it.

But if you want B-roll to cut away to, I'll show you how to add free clips from Pexels and Pixabay using your own API keys. Now, first, what is a key? A key is like a library card. It lets the plugin search on your behalf.

They're free and they take about 5 minutes each. Your keys stay on your computer and I never see them. They're never part of the plugin. Step 1.

Let's go to Pexels. Type in pexels.com/api and sign in. If you don't have an account, simply click "Join". It is free.

Then click on your API key. For the sake of this demonstration, since I already have an account and an API key, I won't click this because it would reveal my API key. But your API key is shown right here in the middle of the screen. Make sure you copy it.

Okay? With Pexels, you'll be asked to fill out a short form. The app name can be anything, like "My Video Projects" and then copy the key. Step 2.

Go to pixabay.com/api/docs and sign in or click "Join". Then scroll down to "Parameters". Here, where it says "Key", you'll see your API key displayed. For my own safety, security and protection, I won't click "Log In" because then you would see my API key.

Okay? Now, step 3. Where the keys go. In your project folder that you created on your local file, there's a file called "Stock Keys Example".

Open it and paste each key, the string of numbers, between the quotes right here. Then copy it and save it. Once you have it saved, I already have mine, so I'm just going to revert the changes here. I have mine right here.

You will have yours as well once you save it. Okay? Then say to your assistant, "Check my stock keys". First, you must do this part, the Pexels, the Pixabay, and saving those keys to your JSON file in your dedicated folder.

Okay? Once you do that, say "Check my stock keys". We've already been working in this same thread. This is your onboarding chat thread.

Okay? So, you would ask it to check your stock keys. If it doesn't see anything in the folder, it will let you know. Then suggest where to find it and tell you what to do.

In this case, I just added my keys after I had asked it to run the check, and then finally it worked again. It found the keys in the iCloud copy, which is where I have my folder. Okay? So, it tells you it's set for each one it found, and it never prints your keys back to you.

One rule I will repeat, please never share your API keys. Keep those secret. It is for your protection. You don't have to choose both Pexels and Pixabay.

If you would prefer to use just one or the other, that's perfectly fine as well. So, you can say, "Find stock footage for this video, as you are editing for this demo." For the purpose of this course, we

have been working on a little video here from raw footage that I've placed in, and I've asked it to edit for me. But now I want to know if it can find some stock footage that might make it stand out a little, maybe make it a bit more useful.

Now it says both keys are set, and it's searching with a shot list. The shot list is what it's going to provide to you. It goes through Pexels and Pixabay, and begins to look at what would best work for your script. Each shot becomes a search phrase of two to four concrete words.

What's in the frame, not the idea. So, "woman typing 'laptop night' becomes what's in the frame, not the idea of productivity." It goes through each shot and previews it. It tells you from right to left what it shows, and it tells you that it's numbered one to six.

Then it gives you suggestions. You don't have to take the suggestions it gives, it will only download what you choose. Okay? So it gives you a full list and an explanation of what each shot is.

If you are doing a portrait style video, it will search for "portrait." If you're doing a landscape video, it will search for "horizontal" for "landscape." Then it will give you some clues. It told me that it numbered my shot list, but I didn't see any numbers, so I needed to communicate that I don't see the numbers.

The numbers didn't render. That's what it tells me. The numbers didn't render, so it tries to work on the numbers again. It adds them, and now I see everything.

I have shot one, manual work for years. I can choose number one, two, three, four, five, or six. For manual work, I think three. Number three.

Then shot two, people who nod in the meeting. Without fully looking at it, I would say probably one or four, because they look like they're in a meeting. Number two looks like it's in a meeting too, but I don't know if they're necessarily nodding, right? So I think I might go with number one, and shot three, opening the doors of the clinic.

For this one, I would probably say number two. These are the ones that I would choose, and it tells you which ones are from Pixabay. This is from Pixabay. That's from Pexels.

Pexels, Pexels down there. Okay, so I think the ones that I would choose would be, well, I said three, one, and two. Okay, so it looks like my suggestions are also very, very similar to the suggestions my assistant gave me. So I said, okay, let's go on.

It starts to work and creates the storyboard showing what it will look like with the stock footage added to my yap that we are currently editing. It's pretty cool, right? I didn't search for these at all. The system did it for me.

Now that it gives me the full breakdown of what it would look like and how it would be, I can say approve, render both, because it's telling me that version A has a stamp opener, and version B has a gravity drop opener, two effects that I think might go really well with this video. So I asked it to render both. Version A comes out looking like this with the three stock cutaways, and no sound effects have been added yet. Wow.

Okay, this is pretty good. That's version A. Let's take a look at version B. Not bad at all.

Not bad at all. So, of course, I chose version A. I actually like both of them. I could just ask it to give me some additional sound effects and things like that.

One thing you also want to do is ask it for your stock credits, okay? When you ask for the stock credits, say, "Show me my credits," you could say, "Show me my stock credits." Basically, showing the stock credits gives you a credit line for each clip, ready to paste into your caption or description. For the ones I used, the clip was "Woman with a Binder," used at a specific time along with the creator and where it can be found.

All three are under the Pexels license, which allows free use in videos. This is one of the coolest things. You're able to use this free stock footage in your videos and have B-roll to cut away to, especially if you use voiceovers. Now, a few rules the tool follows.

Pixabay requires results to be saved for 24 hours, okay? So the same search within a day doesn't hit their service again. Clips are downloaded before use, never streamed from the site, and it will never bulk download or build you a library of clips you aren't using. Both sites allow free use in videos with limits.

For anything sensitive, like an ad with a recognizable person or brand, read the license page yourself. The terms can change, so check them before you publish commercially. If you hit too many requests, wait a little, and try again. Both sites limit searches, and if a portrait search seems to hide some results, the tool tells you, and you can ask to see everything.

And that is stock footage. It's optional, it's free, and you stay in charge of every clip. That's the last lesson, so you have everything you need. Go and make something wonderful.

Stuck? Email support@c3global.co with what you asked and the exact error. Never include passwords or API keys.